

CONTACT INFORMATION

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Los Angeles, CA 90089	Citizenship: Swiss, U.S. permanent resident

CURRENT POSITION

2025- Assistant Professor, Economics Department, **University of Southern California**

AFFILIATIONS

2026- Invited Researcher, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) North America
2025- Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)
2024- Faculty Affiliate, Center for Effective Global Action (CEGA)
2023- Research Network Affiliate, CESifo

PAST POSITIONS

2024–25 Assistant Professor, Economics Department, **UC Santa Cruz**
2019–24 Assistant Professor, Institute for International Economic Studies, **Stockholm University**
2022/23 Visiting Assistant Professor, SIEPR, **Stanford University**
2018/19 Postdoctoral Associate at Cowles Foundation, **Yale University**

EDUCATION

2018 PhD in Economics, **UC Berkeley**
Dissertation: “Essays on State Capacity and Local Public Goods”
Committee: Frederico Finan, Patrick Kline, Emmanuel Saez, Edward Miguel
Public Policy Research Award, Berkeley Economics Department
National Tax Association Dissertation Award
2012 MSc Statistics, **ETH Zurich**
2010 MSc Economics, **University College London**
2008 BA Social Sciences, **University of Zurich**

PUBLICATIONS

Biasi, Barbara, Lafortune, Julien, and Schönholzer, David (2025): “What Works and For Whom? Effectiveness and Efficiency of School Capital Investments Across the U.S.”, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, Vol. 140(3), 2329-79.
Kelley, Erin, Gregory Lane, and David Schönholzer (2024): “Monitoring in Small Firms: Experimental Evidence from Kenyan Public Transit”, *American Economic Review*, 114(10): 3119-60.
Monarrez, Tomás and David Schönholzer (2023): “Dividing Lines: Racial Segregation Across Local Government Boundaries”, *Journal of Economic Literature*, 61(3): 863-87.

Lafortune, Julien and Schönholzer, David (2022): “The Impact of School Facility Investments on Students and Homeowners: Evidence from Los Angeles”, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 14(3): 254-289.

Mueller, Hannes, Rohner, Dominic, and Schönholzer, David (2022): “Ethnic Violence Across Space”, *Economic Journal*, 132: 709-740.

Biasi, Barbara, Lafortune, Julien, and Schönholzer, David (2021): “School Capital Expenditure Rules and Distribution”, *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 111, 450-54.

WORKING PAPERS

Schönholzer, David and François, Pieter (2026): “Environmental Circumscription and the Origins of the State”, Resubmitted to *Review of Economic Studies*

Schönholzer, David and Weese, Eric (2026): “Creative Destruction in the European State System: 1000-2000”, Resubmitted to *Review of Economic Studies*

McCasland, Jamie, Monarrez, Tomás, Schönholzer, David, and Stamm, Everett (2026): “Shattered Metropolis: The Great Migration and the Fragmentation of Political Jurisdictions”, Conditionally accepted at *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*

Schönholzer, David (2026): “Measuring Preferences for Local Governments”

Peruzzo, Matilda, Schönholzer, David, Barlow, Eve, and François, Pieter (2026): “Modeling Historical Diffusion based on Geographic Characteristics”

Lane, Gregory, Kelley, Erin, and Schönholzer, David (2026): “Information and Strategy in Lemon Markets: Improving Safety in Informal Transit”

Schönholzer, David, Kelley, Erin, and Lane, Gregory (2026): “Safer Driving for a Price: Evidence on Behavior and Habits in Kenyan Minibuses”

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Haynes Foundation Faculty Fellowship, 2026

National Tax Association Dissertation Award, 2018

Public Policy Research Award, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley, 2018

Doctoral Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley, 2016-2017

Lincoln Institute C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, 2016

Swiss National Science Foundation Doc.Mobility Fellowship, 2014, 2015

Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award, UC Berkeley, 2013

5-year Departmental Scholarship, UC Berkeley, 2012

Fulbright Foreign Student Program, 2012 (declined)

Highest Dissertation Mark Prize, University College London, 2010

GRANTS

Yale ISPS Research Grant (\$15,000), 2024, with Barbara Biasi and Julien Lafortune

Spencer Small Grant (\$50,000), 2019, with Barbara Biasi and Julien Lafortune

J-PAL Research Grant (\$48,000), 2019, with Erin Kelley and Gregory Lane

EASST Research Grant Competition (\$47,550), 2016, with E. Dal Bó, F. Finan and K. Omala

Development Economics Challenge Grant (\$12,200), 2016, with F. Manang

Weiss Family Program Fund Grant (\$35,050), 2016, with F. Manang
PEDL Major Research Grant (£359,597), 2015, with E. Kelley, G. Lane and P. Waiganjo
Development Impact Lab Innovate grant (\$25,000), 2015
PEDL ScaleUp ERG (£39,810), 2015, with E. Kelley, G. Lane and P. Waiganjo
PEDL Exploratory Research Grant (£17,180), 2014

PRESENTATIONS

2026 UC Irvine; UC Riverside; Simon Fraser University; UC Merced.
2025 UC Berkeley; NBER Conference on Local Governments; USC Marshall; Monash University; University of New South Wales; University of Melbourne.
2024 UC Santa Cruz; Complexity Science Hub Vienna; University of Washington; UBC.
2023 ASSA; UC Berkeley; CESifo Public Economics conference; University of Tokyo; ETH Zurich; University of Lucerne; AMSE Marseille; Philadelphia Fed; Gothenburg.
2022 ASSA; USC Marshall; UEA Europe; Helsinki GSE; BI Norwegian Business School; Warwick; Essex; UC Santa Cruz; UC Berkeley; UC Santa Barbara; USC; UCLA.
2021 ASSA; CSAE Oxford; EUI; UEA Europe Meeting; Stockholm University; Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) Conference; UEA North America Meeting; EDI Conference.
2020 ASSA; Research Institute of Industrial Economics; Stockholm School of Economics; European University Institute; University of Bonn; Chicago Harris.
2019 UC Berkeley; UC Santa Barbara; Brown University; Yale University; Stockholm University; University of Mannheim; University of Tokyo; UC Santa Cruz.
2018 USC; Northwestern; Columbia; Columbia; Boston University; LSE; Institute for International Economic Studies; Brown University.
2017 UC Berkeley; AllUC Economic History Conference, CalTech; Evidence2Action Smart Government Conference, San Francisco.
2016 UC Berkeley; Society of American Archaeology; Code for America, San Francisco; Stanford Archaeology; CEGA Technology for Infrastructure Monitoring Conference.

REFeree SERVICE

American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Sociological Review, Econometrica, Education Finance and Policy, Journal of Economic Growth, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics

MEMBERSHIPS & ASSOCIATIONS

AEA, NTA, UEA, Econometric Society

TEACHING

Political Economy (PhD-level, USC)
Microeconomics, Econometrics (Undergraduate, UCSC)
Econometrics, Political Economy, Public Economics (PhD-level, Stockholm University)